

COLLECTION · SELLERS

Express home staging

*Getting your property sale-ready in a weekend,
room by room, on a budget*

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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Express home staging

Getting your property sale-ready in a weekend, room by room, on a budget

Home staging isn't decorating: it's marketing. The goal isn't to please YOUR tastes, but to let the greatest number of buyers picture themselves — and to justify a better price, faster.

This guide gives you an express plan, room by room, doable in a weekend and without a big budget. Simple, high-impact moves.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page to check off your tasks, room by room.

Home staging isn't decorating: it's a sales strategy. Done well, it speeds up the sale and improves the offers — often for a few hundred dollars. This guide gets to the essentials, room by room.

The golden rule: the buyer must picture themselves. You depersonalize, you pare down, you bring in light.

CHAPTER

The 3 principles that sell

Understanding the logic before moving a piece of furniture.

1. Declutter: fewer objects = bigger, brighter rooms. It's move #1, free and the most profitable.
2. Depersonalize: put away family photos, mementos and strong tastes so the buyer imagines THEIR life here.
3. Neutralize and clean: subdued colours, a deep clean, neutral smells. A spotless house inspires confidence.

Remember: you don't decorate for yourself, you prepare a product for the market.

These three principles — declutter, depersonalize, bring in light — explain nearly all the effect of home staging. The buyer must be able to picture themselves: the less they see YOUR life, the more they imagine their own. And it costs mostly time, not money.

EMILIE'S TIP

If you do only one thing: declutter massively. Clear out 30% of your things (boxes to the garage or storage). The effect on the perception of space is spectacular and free.

CHAPTER

Exterior and entrance: the first impression

Winning the buyer over before they even step in.

- Façade: lawn mowed, hedges trimmed, driveway clear, bins hidden.
- Front door: clean, a working handle, maybe a coat of paint.
- Interior entrance: clear, bright, welcoming (a mirror, a plant).

The first impression plays out in a few seconds, from the sidewalk: it sets the tone for the whole visit.

The first impression plays out before the entrance: a neat façade, a clear driveway, a welcoming door. A tidy exterior promises a well-kept interior; a neglected one plants doubt from the sidewalk. A few hours of exterior cleanup pay off big.

EMILIE'S TIP

Take a photo of your façade with your phone: the camera often reveals what the eye no longer sees (clutter, wear). Fix what the photo exposes.

CHAPTER

Living areas and kitchen

Showcasing the spaces that sell.

- Living room: clear the traffic paths, maximize the light, a few neutral touches.
- Kitchen: counters almost empty, clean appliances, seals redone if needed.
- Dining room: a simply set table to suggest conviviality.
- Light everywhere: working bulbs, curtains open, a bright ambiance.

The kitchen and the light are two decisive factors: put your energy there first.

The living areas and the kitchen are the spaces that sell: clear the traffic paths, maximize the light, neutralize the décor and make the surfaces shine. A clean, pared-down kitchen, even a modest one, reassures far more than a cluttered one, even a high-end one.

EMILIE'S TIP

Clear kitchen counters give an immediate impression of space and cleanliness. Put everything away except 1 or 2 decorative objects: it's one of the most effective moves there is.

CHAPTER

Bedrooms, bathrooms and finishing touches

Tending to the intimate spaces and the details.

- Bedrooms: neutral, tidy bedding, clear under the beds, decluttered closets (they look bigger).
- Bathrooms: spotless, clean matching towels, clean seals and faucets, a neutral smell.
- Finishing touches: fix what squeaks or sticks, air out, a pleasant temperature on visit day.

The details signal a well-kept house: they reassure the buyer and reduce their attempts to negotiate down.

Bedrooms and bathrooms sell through calm and cleanliness: neutral bedding, clear surfaces, clean seals, no marks. It's the details (smell, light, clear storage) that leave the impression of a healthy, well-kept house.

EMILIE'S TIP

Partly empty your closets before visits: a half-full closet looks bigger and suggests “plenty of storage”. Buyers always open the doors.

CHAPTER

Big effect, small budget

Maximizing impact without breaking the bank.

Home staging doesn't require major work. The most profitable moves are often the cheapest:

- **Declutter** and depersonalize: free, and transformative.
- **Clean** thoroughly: a spotless house looks better kept.
- **Fresh paint** in neutral tones.
- **Light**: brighter bulbs, curtains open.
- Fix the **small visible defects** (handles, seals, faucets).

A few hundred well-placed dollars can speed up the sale and improve the offers.

The most profitable is often the cheapest: declutter, clean thoroughly, refresh the paint in neutral tones, improve the lighting, fix the small visible defects. If you do only one thing, declutter: a pared-down house looks bigger, brighter and better kept.

EMILIE'S TIP

If you do only one thing, declutter. A pared-down house looks bigger, brighter and better kept — and it costs nothing but time.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Declutter 30% of the objects (boxes to store).
2. Make the first impression: façade and entrance.

Within 30 days

1. Deep clean, small repairs, lighting optimization.
2. Prepare each room for the photos and visits.

Next

1. Have professional photos taken once the house is ready.

My staging plan

1. Declutter and depersonalize each room, then clean thoroughly.
2. Refresh the paint in neutral tones and improve the lighting before the photos.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Declutter: remove superfluous objects to visually enlarge the rooms.
 - Depersonalize: neutralize the décor so the buyer can picture themselves.
 - First impression: the perception created from the sidewalk.
 - Neutralize: subdued colours and a clean, bright ambiance.
 - Professional photos: a step to do once the house is prepared.
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- Declutter: remove excess objects to visually enlarge the space.
 - Depersonalize: neutralize the décor so the buyer can picture themselves.
 - Curb appeal: the appeal of the façade and entrance, the first impression.
 - Neutral tones: subdued colours that appeal to the greatest number.
 - Lighting: maximize natural light and warm lighting.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. Home staging is above all:

- A) Personal decorating
- B) Marketing to help the buyer picture themselves
- C) A major renovation
- D) Useless

2. The #1 move, free and the most profitable:

- A) Repainting in bright colours
- B) Decluttering
- C) Changing the kitchen
- D) Buying new furniture

3. Depersonalizing means:

- A) Adding family photos
- B) Putting away mementos and overly marked tastes
- C) Painting in red
- D) Putting nothing away

4. The first impression plays out:

- A) In the bedroom
- B) From the sidewalk, in a few seconds
- C) At the notary
- D) After the sale

5. In the kitchen, a key move is:

- A) Cluttering the counters
- B) Clearing the counters almost completely
- C) Hiding the sink
- D) Turning off the lights

6. Two decisive factors are:

- A) The basement and the garage
- B) The kitchen and the light
- C) The attic and the cellar
- D) The curtains only

7. Partly emptying the closets:

- A) Makes them look smaller
- B) Makes them look bigger and suggests storage
- C) Has no effect
- D) Is forbidden

8. Well-tended details:

- A) Encourage hard downward negotiation
- B) Reassure the buyer and limit negotiation
- C) Don't matter
- D) Scare people off

Answer key

- 1. **B** — You prepare a product for the market (intro and ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — Fewer objects = more perceived space (ch. 1).
- 3. **B** — The buyer must imagine THEIR life (ch. 1).
- 4. **B** — The façade sets the tone (ch. 2).
- 5. **B** — Immediate space and cleanliness (ch. 3).
- 6. **B** — You invest there first (ch. 3).
- 7. **B** — Buyers open the doors (ch. 4).
- 8. **B** — They signal a well-kept house (ch. 4).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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